Sovereignty

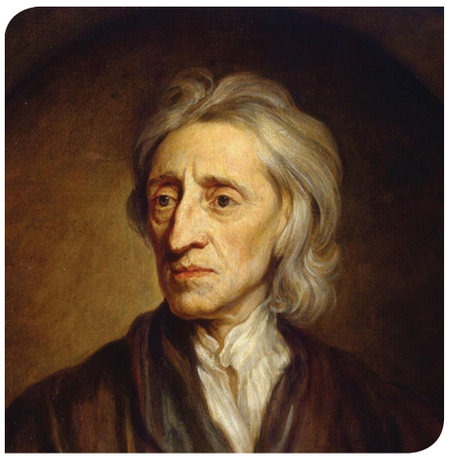
The relationship between the individual and the sovereign was one that was between the absolute absence of power and the absolute unity of power. ***Hobbes*** is consistent in his argument in the commonwealth the removal of all bases of power from the individual on the one hand and the concentration of it with the sovereign was essential. In other words, ***Hobbes*** supported the creation of an absolute sovereign which would lack no power to enforce law and order against any possibility of man's irrationality.. The key to his political thinking is found in the absolute necessity to create an absolute authority. The sovereign could be one man or an assembly of men, although he preferred the sovereignty of one man.

- Fear and liberty are consistent.
- Liberty and necessity are consistent.
- Submission consists of both our obligation and our liberty.
- Other liberties depend on the silence of the law

Assessment

The importance of ***Hobbes*** lies not only on his political philosophy but also on his contributions towards the development of an anti-Aristotelian and thoroughly materialist conception of politics. It is in his work that the beginnings of understanding politics from a non-teleological point of view emerged. His political philosophy served as the basis for other political philosophers such as ***John Locke***, ***Jean-Jacques Rousseau***, Immanuel Kant, who followed the tradition of examining politics from a modern scientific approach.

7.6 John Locke (1632-1704)



Learning Objectives

- To understand the Political thought of ***John Locke***
- To know about ***John Locke*** views on Political Theory, Human Nature, State of Nature, The social Contract.

Life and Times

John Locke, the father of philosophical liberalism, was born on 29 August, 1632 at Wrington, Somersetshire, United Kingdom. He spent his childhood at Pensford, near BristolHis acquaintance with William, the Prince of Orange, and his ascendency to the English throne after the Glorious Revolution of 1688, brought ***Locke*** back to London. ***Locke*** was made the Commissioner for Appeals by William III in 1689. The unfavourable political climate induced him to resign again and led to his settlement at Essex. He ended his public life with his last assignment as the Commissioner on the Board of Tea.

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